

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.5: Subjunctive Morphology and Sequence of Tenses

Form the four ordinary subjunctive tenses and separate morphological identification, sequence, relative time, and syntactic use

Stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisite	EL-II.4 mastery: attach participles and preserve agency and relative time
Next	EL-II.6, Purpose, Result, and Indirect Command

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

Contents

I	Lesson	1
1	Subjunctive morphology and sequence of tenses	1
1.1	The four tenses	1
1.2	Sequence of tenses	2
1.3	Reading the forms in context	2
1.4	Writing laboratory	3
II	Practice	4
1	Transfer, retrieval, and application	4
1.1	The four tenses — transfer practice	4
1.2	Sequence of tenses — transfer practice	4
1.3	Reading the forms in context — transfer practice	4
1.4	Writing laboratory — transfer practice	4
III	Worksheets	5
1	Subjunctive forms and sequence: parallel forms	5
	Worksheet II.17 — Subjunctive A	5
	Worksheet II.20 — Subjunctive D	7
IV	Assessment	8
1	Mastery assessment and record	8
V	Answer Key	9
1	Practice models and rubrics	9
2	Subjunctive forms and sequence: parallel forms	10
	Solution II.17 — Subjunctive A	10
	Solution II.20 — Subjunctive D	11
VI	Scope and Sources	12
1	Scope and Qualifications	12
1.1	Packet boundary	12
1.2	Controlling records and local state	12
2	References	12
2.1	Primary corpus	12
2.2	Grammar and lexicography	13
2.3	Citation convention	13
3	Generation Metadata	13

Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Subjunctive morphology and sequence of tenses

On completing this unit, you can:

- form every active and passive subjunctive of a regular verb and *sum*;
- explain the time relation expressed by each subjunctive tense;
- apply primary and historic sequence in dependent clauses;
- distinguish a morphological identification from a clause's syntactic use.

1.1 The four tenses

The **subjunctive mood** presents an action through the speaker's or sentence's framing—for example as wished, commanded, purposed, resulting, possible, or dependent in reported thought. The **indicative** ordinarily asserts or asks about an action as a fact. Mood is a property of the verb form; the clause type explains why that mood is used in context.

When a subjunctive stands independently, a **jussive** expresses a third-person command, a **hortatory** urges first-person plural action, and an **optative** expresses a wish. In dependent clauses, the conjunction and the clause's function determine its use. These independent uses return in the unit on commands and wishes.

Present and imperfect subjunctive

The present subjunctive uses the tense signs *-e-* in the first conjugation and *-a-* in the others, followed by personal endings:

<i>amare</i>	<i>monere</i>	<i>regere</i>	<i>capere</i>	<i>audire</i>	<i>esse</i>
amem	moneam	regam	capiam	audiam	sim
ames	moneas	regas	capias	audias	sis
amet	moneat	regat	capiat	audiat	sit
amemus	moneamus	regamus	capiamus	audiamus	simus
ametis	moneatis	regatis	capiatis	audiatis	sitis
ament	moneant	regant	capiant	audiant	sint

The imperfect adds personal endings directly to the present active infinitive: *amarem, amares, amaret, amaremus, amaretis, amarent; essem, esses, esset, essemus, essetis, essent*. Passive forms replace active endings with *-r, -ris/-re, -tur, -mur, -mini, -ntur*: *amer, ameris, ametur; amarer, amareris, amaretur*. Deponents use passive morphology with active meaning.

Perfect and pluperfect subjunctive

The perfect active is perfect stem + *-eri-* + personal endings: *amaverim, amaveris, amaverit, amaverimus, amaveritis, amaverint*. The pluperfect active is the perfect active infinitive + personal endings: *amavissem, amavisses, amavisset, amavissemus, amavissetis, amavissent*.

Perfect passive is perfect passive participle + present subjunctive of *sum*: *amatus sim*; pluperfect passive uses imperfect subjunctive: *amatus essem*. The participle always agrees with the subject: *hostiæ oblatæ sint; dona benedicta essent*.

Beware identical-looking forms. *amaverit* can be perfect subjunctive or future perfect indicative; *amaverimus* can be perfect subjunctive or future perfect indicative. Clause environment, not appearance alone, decides.

1.2 Sequence of tenses

Sequence of tenses is the conventional matching of a dependent subjunctive's tense to the time of its governing verb and to whether the dependent action is simultaneous/subsequent or prior. **Primary sequence** uses a present or future viewpoint; **historic sequence** uses a past viewpoint. Sequence locates the dependent action; it does not name the clause's purpose or meaning.

The sequence table

Governing verb	Same or subsequent dependent action	Prior dependent action
Primary: present, future, future perfect, or perfect with present force	present subjunctive	perfect subjunctive
Historic: imperfect, historical perfect, or pluperfect	imperfect subjunctive	pluperfect subjunctive

Sequence locates dependent action relative to the governing action. It does not itself tell why the subjunctive is used. First label the clause—purpose, result, indirect command, question, *cum*, and so forth—then state sequence. Writers may use primary sequence after a historical present, preserve a perfect for a completed result, or use a tense required by an independent condition. Those are meaningful choices, not permission to ignore the table.

1.3 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: present sequence at the Orate fratres

Worked passage ID: W.II.17; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.

Analysis. *Fiat* is third-person singular present subjunctive of *fiō*; it follows the present-time imperative *orate* and expresses action subsequent to the prayer. Morphology is present; the English sense is “may become/be made.”

Translation. “Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable before God, the almighty Father.”

Worked example: anterior action within the Canon

Worked passage ID: W.II.18; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Ut quotquot ex hac altaris participatione sacrosanctum Filii tui Corpus et Sanguinem sumpserimus, omni benedictione cælesti et gratia repleamur.

Analysis. Perfect subjunctive *sumpserimus* is prior to present subjunctive *repleamur*. The latter is first-person plural present passive. The sequence asks that all of us who have received may then be filled.

Translation. “That all of us who have received the most holy Body and Blood of your Son from this sharing in the altar may be filled with every heavenly blessing and grace.”

Worked example: historic sequence before the Passion

Worked passage ID: W.II.19; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Qui pridie quam pateretur, accepit panem.

Analysis. *Pateretur* is third-person singular imperfect subjunctive of the deponent *patior*. With historic *accepit*, *pridie quam* places the anticipated suffering after the taking of bread.

Translation. “Who, on the day before he was to suffer, took bread.”

Worked example: historic indirect command (Mark 5:10)

Worked passage ID: W.II.20; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Et deprecabatur eum multum, ne se expelleret extra regionem.

Analysis. Imperfect *deprecabatur* governs an indirect command. Imperfect subjunctive *expelleret* is same/subsequent in historic sequence; *se* is its accusative object and refers to the speaker.

Translation. “And he earnestly begged him not to drive him out of the region.”

1.4 Writing laboratory

Write from memory the present active table for all five conjugations and *sum*. Beneath each form write its passive counterpart. Then produce all four subjunctive tenses of *benedico* in third-person singular and plural, active and passive.

Build two time diagrams. Under *rogat*, place *veniat* and *venerit*; under *rogavit*, place *veniret* and *venisset*. Compose one Latin sentence for each diagram and explain its relative time in English.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 The four tenses — transfer practice

Connection. A morphology-before-use flowchart prevents a familiar translation from assigning a construction prematurely.

Transfer task. For twelve lesson forms, follow four boxes: identify stem and markers, state person/number/tense/voice/mood, list any formal ambiguity, and only then open the clause context.

Retrieval check. Recite the formation cue for each of the four ordinary subjunctive tenses.

1.2 Sequence of tenses — transfer practice

Connection. A two-axis chart separates governing sequence from the dependent action's relative time.

Transfer task. Place primary and historic governing verbs on one axis and same/subsequent and prior dependent time on the other. Fill the four lesson tense choices and add one project-composed English scenario to each cell without composing new Latin.

Retrieval check. State which dependent tenses ordinarily fill the four cells.

1.3 Reading the forms in context — transfer practice

Connection. Only after morphology and sequence are fixed can governor and signal support a use label.

Transfer task. For each subjunctive in one lesson reading, write a four-line dossier: full parse, governing word, connective or signal, and narrowest defensible use. Add any genuine ambiguity instead of forcing one label.

Retrieval check. Explain why *ut* plus subjunctive is not enough evidence by itself for purpose.

1.4 Writing laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. A time diagram tests sequence while keeping syntactic use constant.

Transfer task. Use the lesson's *rogat/rogavit* diagrams. Replace only the governing time and select the dependent tense that preserves same or prior relation; label the relation before checking the model.

Retrieval check. State what changed and what stayed constant in each pair.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Subjunctive forms and sequence: parallel forms

Worksheet II.17 — Subjunctive A

Worksheet ID: II.17

Focus: four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence

Use: Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give the present active subjunctive of *amo*.

-
2. Give third singular and plural, all four active subjunctive tenses of *benedico*.
-

3. Choose by sequence:

Rogat ut ille (venire) _____; *rogavit ut ille (venire)* _____.

4. Choose prior action: *Scit quid (facere)* _____; *sciebat quid (facere)* _____.
-

5. **Text:** *Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.*

Passage ID: II.17.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *fiat* and explain sequence.

6. Write in Latin: “He asks that the gifts be blessed; he asked that they be blessed.”
-

Worksheet II.20 — Subjunctive D**Worksheet ID:** II.20**Focus:** four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence**Use:** Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give third singular and plural present subjunctive of all five model conjugations.

2. Give the four third-plural passive subjunctives of *offero*.

3. Complete the sequence grid for *dicit/dixit* + same action and prior action.

4. Parse *sint* in *ut dona sancta sint* and *sunto* in a rubric.

5. **Text:** *Et deprecabatur eum multum, ne se expelleret extra regionem.*

*Passage ID: II.20.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.*Parse both verbs and explain reference of *se*.

6. Write a primary and historic pair meaning “He asks/asked that what was offered be received.”

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Produce at least 44 of 48 prompted subjunctive forms within the stated interval, classify primary/historic and same/prior time correctly in all ten clauses, and explain both tense and use in an unseen passage.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-II.6, Purpose, Result, and Indirect Command.

If it is not met: Worksheets II.18 and II.19 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

The four tenses — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The forms must be generated by the lesson's present-subjunctive markers, present infinitive plus endings for imperfect, perfect-stem formation for perfect, and perfect infinitive plus endings for pluperfect, with passive formations preserved. No clause-use label belongs before morphology is complete.

Sequence of tenses — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Primary plus same/subsequent ordinarily uses present subjunctive; primary plus prior uses perfect; historic plus same/subsequent uses imperfect; historic plus prior uses pluperfect. The scenario must preserve those time relations.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The dossier must consider the governing expression, internal markers, negation, sequence, and discourse force. *ut* introduces several clause families, so subjunctive mood and connective alone do not distinguish them.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The governing sequence and dependent tense change together, while the intended relative-time relation and clause dependency remain constant. Correct pairs follow the four-cell sequence chart rather than an English tense imitation.

CHAPTER 2

Subjunctive forms and sequence: parallel forms

Solution II.17 — Subjunctive A

Worksheet ID: II.17

Focus: four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence

Use: Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give the present active subjunctive of *amo*.
Answer / model: *amem, ames, amet, amemus, ametis, ament*.
2. Give third singular and plural, all four active subjunctive tenses of *benedico*.
Answer / model: *benedicat/benedicant; benediceret/benedicerent; benedixerit/benedixerint; benedixisset/benedixissent*.
3. Choose by sequence:
Rogat ut ille (venire) _____; rogavit ut ille (venire) _____.
Answer / model: *veniat; veniret*. Both are same/subsequent; the first follows primary, the second historic sequence.
4. Choose prior action: *Scit quid (facere) _____; sciebat quid (facere) _____.*
Answer / model: *fecerit; fecisset*. Perfect follows primary, pluperfect historic.
5. **Text:** *Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.*
Passage ID: II.17.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Parse *fiat* and explain sequence.
Answer / notes: Third singular present subjunctive of *fi*, subsequent to the primary-time imperative *orate*.
 “Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable before God, the almighty Father.”
6. Write in Latin: “He asks that the gifts be blessed; he asked that they be blessed.”
Answer / model: *Rogat ut dona benedicantur; rogavit ut dona benedicerentur*. Present and imperfect passive follow their respective sequences.

Solution II.20 — Subjunctive D

Worksheet ID: II.20

Focus: four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence

Use: Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give third singular and plural present subjunctive of all five model conjugations.

Answer / model: *amet/ament, moneat/moneant, regat/regant, capiat/capiant, audiat/audiant.*

2. Give the four third-plural passive subjunctives of *offero*.

Answer / model: *offerantur, offerrentur, oblati sint, oblati essent*; for neuter gifts, *oblata sint/essent*.

3. Complete the sequence grid for *dicit/dixit* + same action and prior action.

Answer / model: Primary: present subjunctive for same/subsequent, perfect for prior. Historic: imperfect for same/subsequent, pluperfect for prior.

4. Parse *sint* in *ut dona sancta sint* and *sunto* in a rubric.

Answer / model: *Sint*: third plural present subjunctive of *sum*; *sunto*: third plural future imperative, “they shall be.”

5. **Text:** *Et deprecabatur eum multum, ne se expelleret extra regionem.*

Passage ID: II.20.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse both verbs and explain reference of *se*.

Answer / notes: *Deprecabatur*: third singular imperfect indicative deponent; *expelleret*: third singular imperfect active subjunctive in historic sequence. *Se* refers to the one begging. “He earnestly begged him not to drive him out of the region.”

6. Write a primary and historic pair meaning “He asks/asked that what was offered be received.”

Answer / model: *Rogat ut quod oblatum sit accipiat; rogavit ut quod oblatum esset acciperetur.*

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.5, *Subjunctive Morphology and Sequence of Tenses*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet establishes form and sequence; the following modules classify the major syntactic uses.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Reuse and rights. To the extent Triptych holds the rights, project-created content and design are licensed under CC BY 4.0. Scripture, liturgical or official texts, received prayers or hymns, quotations, fonts, and other third-party material retain their own status; public-domain material remains public domain. Identify changes. Attribution implies neither Triptych nor ecclesiastical approval. See LICENSE and THIRD_PARTY.md in the source.